

Competitive Battlecard: Airbnb Experiences vs. Roamly Groups

Target Segment: Reluctant Milestone Organizers (6–10 adults; bachelorettes, birthdays)

Primary Motion: Product-Led Conversion (Group Hold & Split Checkout)

1. Know the Landscape

- **Competitor Overview:** Broad travel aggregator offering hundreds of thousands of uncurated, open-marketplace activities as an add-on to its core lodging ecosystem.
- **Key Offerings:** Public group walking tours, cooking classes, tastings, outdoor excursions, and photo shoots.
- **Pricing Model:**
 - **Guest Fee:** Dynamic 14–20% service fee added at checkout.
 - **Host Fee:** ~20% commission on gross booking value.
 - **Payment Terms:** Single-payer checkout only; 100% upfront on one credit card. No split payment or reservation hold options for activities.

2. Understand the Battlefield

Strategic Dimension	Airbnb Experiences	Roamly Groups
Key Strengths	• Lodging Anchor: Controls party dates and headcount upstream via home bookings. • Brand Ubiquity: Massive consumer awareness; cards on file for fast checkout. • Catalog Scale: Hundreds of thousands of listings globally.	• Native Group Checkout: 24-hr calendar holds with individual split pay. • Vetted Quality: 12,000 vetted experts across 40 cities; no low-effort filler. • Private Buyouts: Built specifically for private milestone celebrations.

Key Weaknesses	• Single-Card Barrier: Forces one person to float large balances. • Uneven Quality: Open marketplace with inconsistent standards. • Low Product Priority: Experiences exist primarily to boost lodging retention.	• Zero Lodging Funnel: Must acquire organizers without an attached home booking. • Challenger Brand: Friends paying via link may not know Roamly. • Limited Footprint: Restricted to 40 core global markets.
-----------------------	--	---

3. Win the Deal

- **Why Roamly Wins:**
 - **Eliminates Financial Liability:** Organizers lock the host's calendar for 24 hours while each member pays their own share.
 - **Zero-Friction Guest Checkout:** Invitees pay in seconds via mobile browser (Apple Pay/Google Pay)—no app downloads or accounts required.
 - **High-Stakes Reliability:** Rigorous host vetting prevents poor-quality experiences during milestone events.
- **Why Airbnb Wins:**
 - **Incidental & Low-Priced Bookings:** Solo travelers or couples looking for a \$35 walking tour on demand.
 - **Contextual Checkout Prompts:** Immediate cross-sell modal appearing right after a user books an Airbnb home.
- **Where They Overlap:**
 - Groups frequently book lodging on Airbnb, but leave the platform to book private, high-ticket headline events on Roamly.

4. Handle the Hard Moments

The Quick Dismiss

"Airbnb is great for booking your stay or finding a quick walking tour. For the main event—where you need a private buyout for \$8 without floating \$1,500 on your

card or chasing Venmos—Roamly holds the date and collects from everyone directly."

Landmine Questions

- *"Who in your group chat is volunteering to float the entire \$1,800 balance on their personal card today?"*
- *"What happens to that booking if two people back out three days before the trip?"*
- *"Have you checked the host's recent independent reviews, or are you gambling on open-catalog photos for your best friend's celebration?"*

Objection Handling

- **"Everyone already has the Airbnb app and saved cards."**
 - *Response: "That's why Roamly Groups uses no-download guest checkout. Your friends don't create accounts or download anything; they tap your link and pay their share via Apple Pay in 10 seconds."*
- **"Airbnb has way more options."**
 - *Response: "They do, because anyone can list. That leaves you sifting through reviews to avoid a dud. Roamly caps its catalog at vetted experts so your core event is guaranteed to deliver."*
- **"We can just book on Airbnb and settle via Splitwise/Venmo."**
 - *Response: "You can, but that leaves you holding the debt if someone drags their feet or cancels late. Roamly locks the calendar for 24 hours and enforces the payment deadline automatically."*